

Getting started: Shanumkha Invoices & Stock

The app is installed on **every computer** that uses it. All computers share **one online database (Neon)**, so a change made by anyone shows up for everyone, and each person only sees and changes what their login allows. Setting up a computer takes about 15 minutes; you don't need to type commands.

Step 0: Create the shared database (administrator, once only)

Neon is a company that keeps your database online, safely, with automatic backups. It is **not a website**: nobody can see it, and nothing appears in Google. Only computers that have the connection string can reach it.

1. Go to **<https://neon.tech>** → **Sign up** (you can use your Google account).
2. Create a **project**: name it `shanumkha`. For **Region** choose the one closest to you, e.g. **AWS Asia Pacific (Singapore)**. Click **Create project**.
3. On the project dashboard click **Connect**. Keep **Connection pooling** switched on, then click **Copy snippet** or the copy button next to the connection string. It looks like `postgresql://neondb_owner:xxxx@ep-xxxx-pooler.ap-southeast-1.aws.neon.tech/neondb?sslmode=require`
4. Keep this connection string **private**, like a bank password. You'll paste it once on each computer (Step 3). Send it to your team personally (e.g. WhatsApp to the person, not a group), never by public email.

The free Neon plan is enough to start with. After a few minutes of no use, Neon pauses the database; the first click after that can take a second or two, then everything is fast again.

Step 1: Install Python (one time only)

Python is the free engine the app runs on.

1. Open **<https://www.python.org/downloads/>** in your browser.
2. Click the yellow **Download Python 3.x** button (any version 3.10 or newer is fine).
3. Open the downloaded file.
4. **Windows: on the first screen, tick ☒ "Add python.exe to PATH"** at the bottom. This is important.
5. Click **Install Now** and wait until it says *Setup was successful*. Close the installer.

(Mac: open the downloaded .pkg file and click Continue → Install.)

Step 2: Put the app folder on your computer

1. Find the downloaded **Shanumkha-Invoices.zip** (usually in *Downloads*).
2. **Windows:** right-click it → **Extract All...** → choose **Documents** → **Extract**. **Mac:** double-click the zip, then drag the **Shanumkha-Invoices** folder into **Documents**.
3. You now have a folder **Documents\Shanumkha-Invoices**. Don't run the app from inside the zip.

Your data will be saved inside this folder (in the `instance` folder). Don't delete it.

Step 3: Start the app

Windows: open the folder and double-click **Start-Windows.bat**.

- If a blue box says "*Windows protected your PC*": click **More info** → **Run anyway**. (It appears because the file is new to Windows, not because it is unsafe.)
- A black window opens. **The first time it prepares the app for 1–3 minutes (internet needed)**.
- It then asks "**Where should this computer keep the app's data?**": type **1** (shared online database) and press Enter, then **paste the connection string** (Windows: right-click; Mac: ⌘ Cmd + V) and press Enter. **Nothing appears while you paste. That's on purpose, to keep the password private.** The window then shows the string with the password as `****` and asks you to confirm the database name (it must be **your** database, e.g. `shanmukaconsumersinvoice`, not `neondb`). It checks the connection and saves it. You won't be asked again on this computer.
- **Never share a photo or screenshot of the connection string.** If that happens, reset the password in Neon (Roles → `neondb_owner` → Reset password) and connect again with the new string.
- Your browser then opens the app at **`http://127.0.0.1:8765`**.

Mac: double-click **Start-Mac.command**. The first time, macOS says "*Apple could not verify 'Start-Mac.command'...*". Click **Done** (not "Move to Bin"), then either:

- open ****** → System Settings → Privacy & Security, **scroll down, click** Open Anyway, **enter your Mac password and click** Open Anyway **again**, or**
- open **Terminal** (⌘ Space, type Terminal) and paste this line, then press Enter. It unblocks both Mac files at once: `xattr -dr com.apple.quarantine ~/Documents/Shanumkha-Invoices && bash ~/Documents/Shanumkha-Invoices/Start-Mac.command`

This warning appears for any app not from the App Store; it only has to be allowed once.

Keep the black window open while you use the app. Closing it stops the app. To start again tomorrow, double-click **Start-Windows.bat** again (it will be fast after the first time). If the browser didn't open, open it yourself and go to **http://127.0.0.1:8765**.

Step 4: Create the administrator login (first computer only)

On the **very first computer** connected to the new database, the first page asks you to **create the administrator**. Enter your name, a username and a password (at least 8 characters). **Write it down somewhere safe.**

On every other computer you'll see the **Log in** page instead: log in with the username and password the administrator gave you.

Already used the app on this computer before Neon? When you paste the connection string, the app offers to **copy this computer's data into the shared database** (only if the shared database is still empty). Type **y**.

Step 5: Enter your business details

Click **Settings** in the menu and fill in your business name, address, GSTIN, phone, bank/UPI details and terms. Check the invoice prefix (**SCP**) and the default payment due days. Click **Save settings**. These details print on every invoice.

Step 6: Add logins for your team

Click **Users & access** → **+ Add user** for each person (partners, investors, staff):

1. Enter their name, a username and a starting password.
2. Choose a **Role**. This fills in suggested access.
3. In **Access to each section**, set each section to *No access*, *View only* or *View & edit*.
4. Click **Save**. Give them their username and password; they can change the password under **My account**.

Step 7: Add your products and stock

Either:

- **Products** → **+ Add product** for each item (name, code, HSN, UOM, price, GST %, opening stock, reorder level), **or**

- **Products** → **Upload stock file** and choose a PDF, Excel or Word purchase bill / stock list. Check the preview and click **Update stock**. The file `samples/stock-upload-template.xlsx` shows a simple layout you can fill in.

Step 8: Add customers and make your first invoice

1. **Customers** → **+ Add customer** (name, address, mail ID, phone, city).
2. Click **+ New invoice**, choose the customer, add items, set **Payment due (days)**, then **Save invoice**.
3. Click **Print / Save PDF** to print it or save it as a PDF. It then appears under **Dispatch**.

Step 9: Make it an app with its own icon (optional)

With the app running, install it so it opens in its own window with an icon, like any other app:

- **Google Chrome or Microsoft Edge (Windows or Mac):** open <http://127.0.0.1:8765>, then click the **install icon** at the right end of the address bar (a small screen with a down arrow) → **Install**. Or use the `:` menu → **Cast, save and share** → **Install page as app** (Edge: `⋮` → **Apps** → **Install this site as an app**).
- **Safari on Mac:** open <http://127.0.0.1:8765>, then **File** → **Add to Dock** → **Add**.

The **Shanumkha Invoices** icon then appears in your Dock / Start menu / desktop. Click it to open the app.

The app still needs its black (Terminal) window running in the background. If you click the icon while it isn't running, you'll see a "Can't connect" page. Start it with `Start-Windows.bat` / `Start-Mac.command` and click **Try again**.

Start it automatically when the computer turns on: - **Mac:** System Settings → General → **Login Items** → **+** → choose **Start-Mac.command**. - **Windows:** press **Windows key + R**, type `shell:startup`, press Enter, and put a **shortcut** to **Start-Windows.bat** in the folder that opens (right-click `Start-Windows.bat` → Show more options → Create shortcut, then move the shortcut there).

Everyday use

To...	Do this
Start the app	Double-click Start-Windows.bat (Mac: Start-Mac.command)
Stop the app	Close the black window
See money still to be received	Payments
See what went out of stock	Dashboard or Stock summary & stock out
Record a payment received	Payments → amount → Received

Backups: please do this every week

Neon keeps its own copies of your database. As extra safety, keep your own copy too:

1. On any one computer, double-click **Backup-Windows.bat** (Mac: **Backup-Mac.command**).
2. A full copy of the shared data is downloaded into the **backups** folder inside the app folder.
3. Copy the **backups** folder to a pen drive or Google Drive.

If you ever need to restore from one of these copies, keep the backup file and ask for help: it can be loaded back into a new Neon database.

Getting a newer version later

1. Stop the app and make a backup (above).
2. Extract the new zip to a **new** folder.
3. Copy the **instance** folder from your old app folder into the new folder.
4. Start the app from the new folder. Your data and logins carry over automatically.

Adding another computer (any location, any Wi-Fi)

1. On the new computer do **Step 1** (Python), **Step 2** (unzip) and **Step 3** (start, type **1**, paste the connection string).
2. The person logs in with the username and password the administrator created for them under **Users & access**.

That's all: every computer sees the same invoices, stock, payments and so on, live.

Someone leaves or a laptop is lost? The administrator deactivates their login under **Users & access**. If the laptop itself might be misused, also reset the database password in Neon (**Roles → Reset password**) and paste the new connection string on the other computers (see Troubleshooting: *Change the database*).

Important: every computer that is connected stores the connection string (in `instance\database_url.txt`). Someone with technical skills and access to that computer's files could use it to open the database directly, outside the app and its access rules. Only install the app on computers of people you trust.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
Mac: "Apple could not verify Start-Mac.command"	Click Done , then System Settings → Privacy & Security → Open Anyway (see Step 3).
Mac: a box asks to install "command line developer tools"	Python isn't installed yet. Click Cancel and do Step 1 first.
"Python is not installed"	Install Python (Step 1) and tick "Add python.exe to PATH" . Then restart the computer.
"Something went wrong during setup"	Check the internet connection. Delete the <code>.venv</code> folder inside the app folder and double-click Start again.
Browser says "can't reach this page"	The black window must be open. Wait a few seconds and refresh.
The black window shows an error about the address or port being in use	The app is already running in another black window. Use that one, or close it first.
Forgot the administrator password	Open the app folder, click the address bar, type <code>cmd</code> and press Enter. In the window type <code>.venv\Scripts\flask --app run create-admin</code> and follow the questions.
"Could not connect" / "password authentication failed" when pasting	Copy the connection string again from Neon (Connect), including the password, and paste the whole line.
The app is slow on the first click of the day	Neon was paused to save resources; it wakes up in a second or two.
Change the database (or switch to "this computer only")	Delete the file <code>instance/database_url.txt</code> in the app folder and start the app again; it asks again.
Chrome shows "Access to 127.0.0.1 was denied – HTTP ERROR 403"	You are on an old address. Open http://127.0.0.1:8765 (port 5000 belongs to the Mac's AirPlay Receiver).
Someone is locked out	They typed a wrong password 5 times. Wait 15 minutes, or the admin clicks Unlock under Users & access .